Employer Nomination Scheme visa (subclass 186)

Direct Entry stream

This visa lets skilled workers nominated by an employer live and work in Australia permanently.

Personalise this page...

For Applicants For Sponsors

Overview

Stay

Permanently

Cost

From AUD6,140.00

Concessions apply in limited circumstances.

Cost Concession

From 1 July 2026, a lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid visa application. See About this visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/employer-nomination-scheme-186/direct-entry-stream#About)*.

To see what your visa will cost use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator)*. The estimator does not consider the second instalment or other costs.

Processing times

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/_layouts/15/FIXUPREDIRECT.ASPX?WebId=1057a7be-45e1-4b08-af28-b81c4827a08c&TermSetId=a76074c9-979d-4db3-adcc-34af89495da2&TermId=8d21fa49-19a7-4d58-8bb0-31134b271c2b)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

With this visa, you can

- live, work and study in Australia indefinitely
- sponsor eligible family members to come to Australia
- apply for Australian citizenship, if eligible.

Ask a question

See all conditions *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/see-your-visa-conditions?product=186-3)*

Check your eligibility *(#Eligibility)*

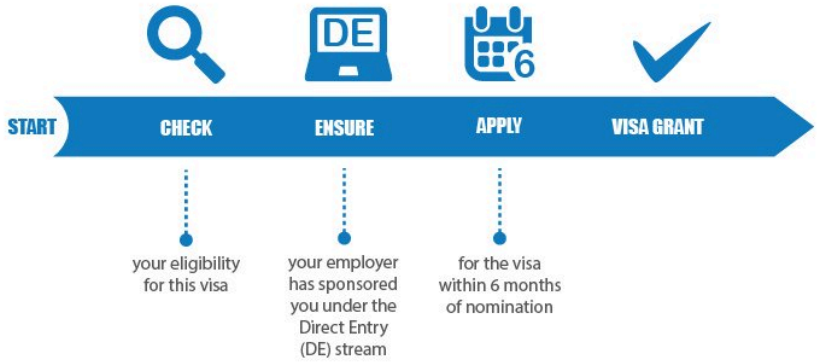
You must

- be under 45 years old on the date you lodge your application, unless exempt
- be nominated for an occupation on the Core Skills Occupation List *(/visas/working-in-australia/skill-occupation-list)*
- have at least 3 years relevant work experience, unless you are exempt
- have a positive skills assessment before you lodge your application, unless you are exempt
- meet minimum standards of English language proficiency *(https://immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/english-language/competent-english)*
- meet health and character requirements.

Help with your visa

If you are getting help with your visa, before you pay someone, read information on Who can help you with your application *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/overview)*.

Process



Last updated:
3 August 2026